

MarketPulse Marketplace - independent final capstone

1. Business decision

Leadership wants to decide where to focus growth/operations effort without damaging margin or service quality.

2. Required workflow

Decision/definitions -> preserve raw -> audit quality -> prepare/join Products -> validate grain/cardinality -> overall/target/trend/segment metrics -> two independent reconciliations -> 2-4 decision-useful visuals -> findings/recommendation/limitations -> GitHub README -> 10-minute walkthrough.

3. Injected issues

The raw data intentionally contains five issue types. Detect and document them yourself; do not use this instruction sheet as an answer key.

4. Independence

No tutorial identifies a winning region/category/channel. Choose tools/methods yourself and keep a traceable evidence path.

Critical-competency rubric

- Business framing: decision/question/scope/definitions.
- Data quality: raw preserved; issue counts/examples/treatment documented.
- Metric/grain: numerator/denominator/exclusions and target Region-Month grain correct.
- Join/model: Product key/cardinality checked; unmatched product remains visible until resolved.
- Analysis: appropriate overall/target/trend/segment comparisons.
- Validation: at least two material metrics reconciled independently.
- Visuals: 2-4 decision-useful, source-consistent, no decorative contradictions.
- Findings: at least three with comparison + magnitude + scope.
- Causal discipline: observational pattern not called cause.
- Recommendation: prioritized action + success measure + risk/limitation.
- README/reproducibility: another analyst can open/run in order.
- Walkthrough/ownership: can defend own choices and one failure/recovery.

Pass standard

ALL 12 critical competencies PASS and no critical failure. No averaging.

Critical failures include wrong denominator/grain, hidden material cleaning, ignored unmatched key, privacy/secret leak, unsupported causal claim, or recommendation unsupported by validated evidence.

Submission and protected review route

- Submit workbook evidence paths, prepared data/code/query paths, metric definitions, quality log, two validation checks, 2-4 visuals, three findings, recommendation, limitations, GitHub README and 10-minute walkthrough notes.
- Save the genuine submission before opening C1_M11_MARKETPULSE_FINAL_CAPSTONE_PROTECTED_REVIEW_RC1.pdf.
- The protected review contains objective anomaly/validation controls, not a single correct dashboard or recommendation.
- If a competency fails, repair that competency and revalidate affected downstream findings before final job-readiness Gate.